Fruit Trail

MUMBAI-PUNE, KONKAN, MAHARASHTRA

Everybody has heard of the Alphonso. No other variety gets so much attention. Or costs as much. It is a pretty fruit, round and plump and orangish. Its orange flesh is fragrant and firm and not very sweet. That's the Alphonso hallmark: it has a subtle blend of sweet and sour, making it a connoisseur's favourite. Two districts in Maharashtra produce the best Alphonsos: Ratnagiri and Sindhudurg. Their best produce comes to the markets of Mumbai and Pune. The biggest name in its cultivation is Desai Bandhu Ambewala (desaibandhuambewale.com) in Ratnagiri. Devgad, close to the town of Malvan that has given us Malvani cuisine, has several beach resorts. (Also look for Pairi, Alphonso's poor cousin, with a stronger taste.)

TRY: Konkan Nest Resort, Ganpatipule, Ratnagiri. Nearby attractions: Prachin Konkan Museum, Ganapatipule Temple, Malgund Beach, Jaigad Fort



The famed Alphonso

YOGESH MORE/ALAMY



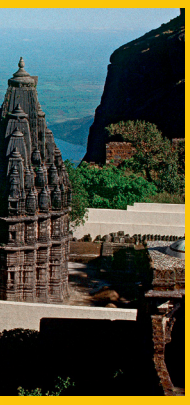
GOA

Goa's mango riches are not well-known outside the little coastal state. Orchards are small and the produce is locally consumed. But if you visit the island of Chorao near Old Goa, you will find several orchards with a selection of the prized Goan mango varieties. The Mankurad has become a high-profile variety in recent years. It is closely related to the Alphonso but its flesh is sweeter, creamier and has more fibre. There are several delicious varieties not known outside Goa, like Fernandin and Hilario and Furtado. Production is small-scale, so what you get depends on when you visit, and which local market is close by.

TRY: 'The Island Sanctuary: A Village Secret' at Pandavaddo House on Chorao Island



The Island Sanctuary at Pandavaddo House on Chorao Island, Goa and (inset) Mankurad mangoes



JUNAGADH, SAURASHTRA, GUJARAT

Bollywood actress Parveen Babi was only one of the national treasures to come from here. The sweet, orange flesh of Junagadh's Kesar mango has inspired many a Gujarati trader to take a long trip to the orchards around Junagadh. The flesh of the Kesar has little fibre, is creamy enough to cut with a knife for the table, yet not so creamy that it won't yield the kind of runny juice that hits the Ras-Puri spot in the Gujarati palate. Which is why it becomes most important to ask Gujarati leaders how they like to take their mango. Look out for two regional favourites: Vanraj and Rajapuri.

TRY: Hotel Anil Farmhouse near Sasan Gir, which has its own nursery orchard, or try the Mango Orchard Club & Resort in Vadodara (themangoorchard.in)



Junagadh's Kesar mango